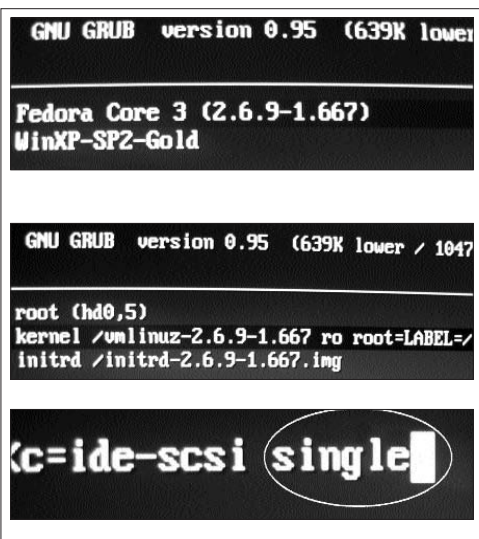


2. Next, scroll to the line that starts with the word “kernel” and again hit [E] to edit it. Go to the end of that line, add a space and type in “single”.
3. Press [Esc] to get to the main boot options screen, and then boot into Linux. Instead of getting the GUI, a command prompt appears where you can carry out system maintenance tasks. If you have observed, you have not been asked for the root password till this point and you are already given access to root commands! You can change the root password here as well. Yes, for those of you who are wondering, this is a security issue, but it is possible to do away with this risk by editing configuration files such that even in Single User mode, a password is asked for.

If you use LILO to boot Linux, just type in “linux single” at the LILO command prompt.

Once you’re in Single User mode, you can change the root password with the “passwd root” command. Then you can reboot, go into the GUI and change all the other user passwords as well. This is how you can get back into a Linux system after you lose your root password.



Using the steps above, virtually anyone can set his own root password without knowing the original one. You have to realise that the idea of root is basically to prevent users from accidentally deleting other’s data or modifying critical system files. Anyone